

Diego Fortes

Independent Software Architect | Web, iOS & Android Apps

daigof@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/fortesdiego | github.com/daigof



Summary

Independent Software Architect with 17+ years of experience building web platforms and mobile applications, designing frontend architecture, and delivering full-stack SaaS products. Experienced as a startup co-founder, enterprise technical lead, open-source contributor, and senior frontend consultant. Currently building independent web, iOS, and Android applications, with a strong focus on TypeScript, React, product architecture, developer tooling, performance, and reliable user experiences.

Key Areas of Expertise

- **Zero-to-one engineering:** Built secure, multi-tenant SaaS platforms from scratch.
- **Frontend modernization:** Migrated legacy systems (PHP, Java, AngularJS, etc.) to modern React, Vite, and TypeScript architectures.
- **Technical leadership:** Led contractor teams, mentored engineers, shaped product schemas, and collaborated across English- and Spanish-speaking teams.
- **Independent app development:** Building web, iOS, and Android applications from product concept through implementation and release.
- **TypeScript and product architecture:** Designed maintainable application structures, reusable frontend systems, and pragmatic full-stack integrations.
- **Performance and reliability:** Improved build systems, runtime performance, asset pipelines, testing, and cloud/security delivery.

Experience

Independent Developer | Web, iOS & Android Apps

May 2026 - Present | Remote

- Building independent web, iOS, and Android applications focused on practical product design, maintainable implementation, and reliable user experiences.
- Developing portfolio projects and experiments published at nobsapps.co.
- Owning product direction, frontend architecture, API integration, deployment, and release workflows across small, focused applications.

HoundDog.ai | Co-Founder & Staff Engineer

February 2024 - May 2026 | San Francisco Bay Area

- Built the HoundDog.ai SaaS platform from scratch as the sole frontend developer using Remix, TypeScript, shadcn/ui, and Tailwind CSS.
- Implemented atomic state management with Jotai and multi-tenant authentication using PropelAuth.
- Improved core scanning infrastructure, contributing system-level enhancements to a Rust-based AST scanner.
- Extended backend capabilities by designing and building Django REST APIs for full-stack product features.

Atlas Health | Senior Frontend Engineer

August 2022 - January 2024 | Seattle, Washington

- Modernized the frontend build pipeline by migrating the core platform from Create React App to Vite, reducing build and test times from minutes to seconds while removing legacy security issues.

- Led the transition to TypeScript and helped establish a type-safe codebase.
- Reworked unsafe Redux state management into a more predictable atomic architecture with Jotai.
- Improved engineering standards by configuring ESLint, Prettier, and TypeScript tooling.
- Added automated end-to-end test coverage with Cypress.
- Mentored junior engineers on React, TypeScript, frontend architecture, and code quality practices.
- Supported staff-level architecture discussions, including technical feasibility, database schema design, and user interface decisions.

Toptal | Senior Frontend Engineer

December 2015 - August 2022 | US- and UK-based companies, Remote

- Delivered senior frontend and full-stack consulting engagements for global companies through the Toptal network.
- Specialized in modern frontend infrastructure, framework migrations, developer tooling, performance improvements, and long-term maintainability.
- Selected engagements include Curology, PaidUp, iwoca, Sellr, CUPS, Listen360, PVBid, and DoubleNet Pay.

Curology | Senior Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

January 2019 - August 2022

- Led the migration of the core web platform from a legacy PHP architecture to a modern React stack using Gatsby and Emotion.
- Maintained and improved client-facing applications built with React, TypeScript, and MobX.
- Built features for internal administrative tools, improving operational workflows and interface efficiency.
- Migrated Radiance UI, Curology's open-source component library, to TypeScript.
- Used Storybook to document reusable components and scalable design patterns.

Restoration Media | Senior Full-Stack Engineer

August 2017 - September 2018

- Built and launched four full-stack web applications with admin panels using Angular, Node.js, Express, and MongoDB.
- Designed a unified authentication architecture with Passport.js and Google OAuth to support single sign-on across multiple platforms.
- Built a custom frontend asset pipeline with Gulp for EJS templates and LESS compilation.
- Established backend test coverage using Mocha, Chai, Sinon, and Supertest, consistently maintaining more than 80% coverage.
- Integrated third-party services including Google DFP, AdButler, AWS S3, and SendGrid.

PaidUp - Stop Chasing Payments | Senior Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

January 2018 - July 2018

- Redesigned and modernized the core web platform by migrating the legacy stack to Vue.js.
- Built a fully responsive, mobile-first interface focused on maintainability and cross-device usability.

iwoca | Senior Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

January 2018 - February 2018

- Built a high-performance server-side rendered web platform using Gatsby, React, GraphQL, and Contentful CMS.
- Designed custom CMS data models in Contentful and structured the GraphQL schema, queries, and mutations for efficient content delivery.
- Implemented custom responsive interfaces with React and Stylus, optimizing rendering performance across device sizes.

Sellr | Senior Full-Stack Engineer, via Toptal

August 2016 - July 2017

- Maintained and improved four full-stack web applications backed by Node.js, Express, MongoDB, and MySQL.
- Redesigned two core applications with custom responsive interfaces, replacing rigid framework-driven layouts.
- Built three hybrid mobile applications with AngularJS and Ionic for iPad and mobile phone form factors.

- Extended a React-based product discovery application with advanced listing, filtering, and client-side state management.

CUPS | Full-Stack Engineer, via Toptal

March 2016 - May 2017

- Modernized the frontend architecture by migrating the platform from React 0.14 to React 15.
- Built a lightweight CMS solution with an EJS template engine backed by structured JSON content models.
- Developed Node.js and Express infrastructure, including middleware, secure routes, and REST endpoints.
- Integrated Google Maps API features for location search, spatial querying, and proximity rendering.
- Designed a telemetry and analytics tracking engine using ES6+ and Babel.

Listen360 | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

February 2016 - December 2016

- Converted high-fidelity Photoshop designs into production web interfaces with strong visual accuracy.
- Built customized interactive UI components by extending and styling third-party jQuery plugins.
- Developed a responsive, mobile-first layout using SASS.
- Improved platform interactivity with modular JavaScript and jQuery.

PaidUp - Stop Chasing Payments | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

April 2016 - May 2016

- Led greenfield frontend development for a new web application using AngularJS and Browserify.
- Built a responsive, mobile-first interface with Materialize CSS and LESS.
- Helped modernize the product by contributing to the migration toward Vue.js.

DoubleNet Pay | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

2016

- Refactored a legacy web platform by modularizing Backbone.js and Handlebars components.
- Built an automated Gulp pipeline for minification, concatenation, and cache-busting.
- Converted InVision prototypes into responsive interfaces with strong visual fidelity across device sizes.

PVBid, Inc. | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

2016

- Improved client-side runtime performance by analyzing AngularJS workflows and migrating critical interactions to lightweight JavaScript and jQuery.
- Modernized the application presentation layer with modular SASS and interactive jQuery components.

Southapps | Frontend Engineer

August 2015 - December 2015

- Built and launched a cross-platform mobile application using Ionic and AngularJS.
- Developed and styled more than 30 application screens from high-fidelity UI/UX mockups.
- Created modular SASS styles for reusable, maintainable mobile interfaces.

ExxonMobil | Project Technical Lead & Senior Web Developer

September 2011 - December 2015

- Led technical direction for two enterprise-scale initiatives: the global redesign of ExxonMobil's public-facing web presence and the migration of a Java B2B platform into an Angular single-page application.
- Directed cross-functional development teams contracted from Deloitte, maintaining code quality, delivery milestones, and architecture standards for a platform processing millions of dollars in daily transactions.
- Designed and supported global corporate web applications, including a legacy enterprise CMS migration from Documentum to Sitecore.
- Owned enterprise web infrastructure administration and integration across Akamai CDN, Google Search Appliance, and Webtrends analytics.

IBM | Web Application Engineer

2011 - 2012

- Maintained and improved an enterprise J2EE web application within IBM's global Procurement department.
- Built client-side features with vanilla JavaScript and Prototype.js to support frontend performance and cross-browser behavior.
- Implemented RESTful web services to integrate backend business logic and internal data flows.
- Wrote SQL queries and managed persistence logic for IBM DB2 databases.

Dridco, Zonaprop.com | Full-Stack Engineer

2010 - 2011

- Built and optimized features for a high-traffic e-commerce web application using Java, Spring Framework, and Hibernate.
- Modernized frontend interactions with jQuery Tools and jQuery UI.
- Wrote SQL scripts to improve data structures, indexes, and storage behavior across Oracle and SQL Server environments.
- Collaborated with product and engineering teams to deliver full-stack features across backend services and user interfaces.

Globant | Web Engineer, Contracted to EMC Corporation

2009 - 2010

- Supported global enterprise digital platforms for EMC Corporation using Documentum.
- Built data-driven layouts with XSLT, semantic HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Developed custom WordPress themes with modular CSS.
- Created accessible HTML and CSS assets for internet marketing campaigns with strong email-client compatibility.

Enexum | Web Developer

2008 - 2009

- Built accessible layouts and interactive user interfaces with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Debugged and resolved cross-browser compatibility issues across multiple web applications.
- Supported enterprise client work involving XSLT data transformations and server-side content delivery.

Education

- **UNLP, Universidad Nacional de La Plata** - Master's Degree, Computer Software Engineering, 2010 - 2011
- **Universidad Tecnológica Nacional** - Engineering Degree, Information Systems Engineering, 2003 - 2009
- **Universidad Tecnológica Nacional** - Analyst Degree, Information Systems Analyst, 2003 - 2007